

Project Management for Digital Cultural Heritage



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Why does it matter?

How are Digital Heritage Projects Designed and Built

Three common stages in projects:



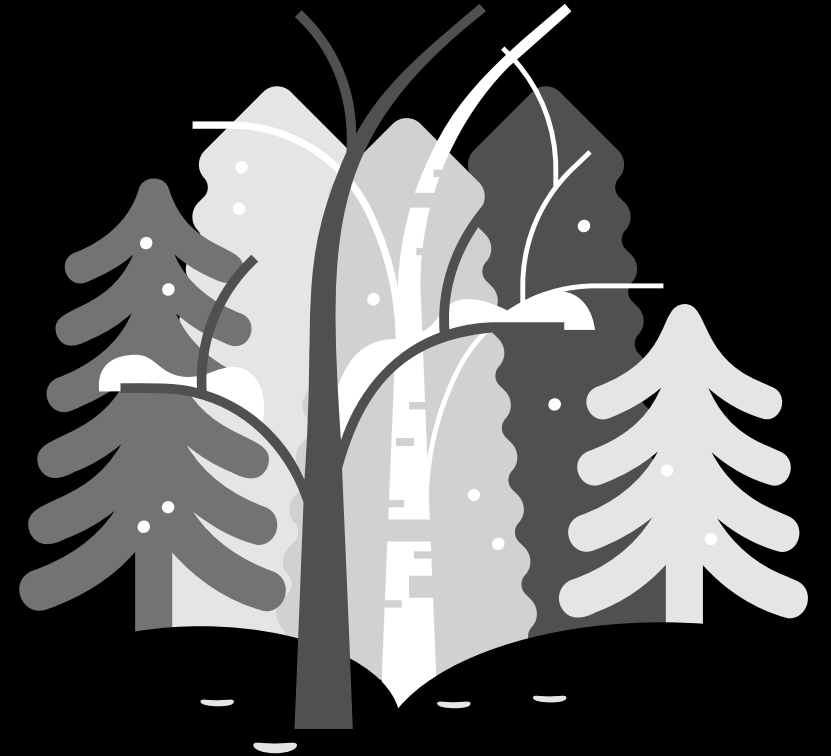
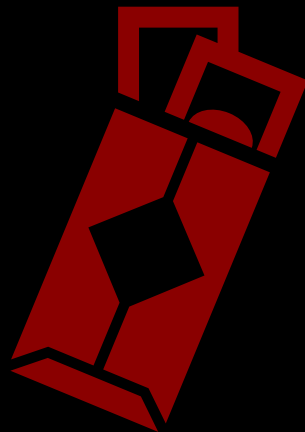
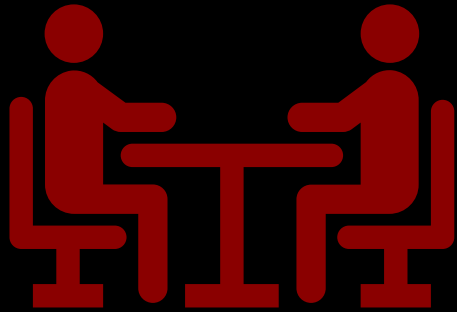
Project Lifecycle

Developing the concept

Environmental Scan

Partners

Funding



Building a Vision Document

Vision Document



Project Vision Document Template

*The project vision document is the initial (and often foundational) statement about your project. It provides a platform to communicate (and collaborate on) the shape and scope of your project with other core project partners and potential external collaborators. A project vision document should **never exceed 2 pages**.*

Title:

What is your project's name? You should not only think about the name itself, but how that translates into a domain/URL

Project Description:

Describe the project. What are its motivations and intellectual significance. Why is it important? Why is it meaningful? Why is it significant? What sort of need does it address? What sort of intervention does it make.

Deliverables/Outcomes:

What will be the end result, what will the project produce. If it will result in a website, discuss that website. Based on your project name, what is its domain/URL (remember, a domain name is an important part of a project's visibility/promotion/recognition).

Functionality & Technology

Describe the functionality of the project (what will it do, how will users interact with it, how will it present content). What sorts of technology (generally) will be used to build all aspects of the project. Where will it live (where will users interact with it).

Audience:

Who is the audience (and why)? Think about how will you build community among your audience?

Data, Information, Content

What is the core content/data of the site? Is data being drawn from somewhere else (a museum or archive). If so, what is that data/content and where is it coming from? Remember, if you are drawing data/content from another institution (museum, digital library, archive, etc), you should consider including them as partners.

Environmental Scan

Briefly identify and discuss similar projects. "Similarity" can be in content, focus, audience, technology, user experience, etc.

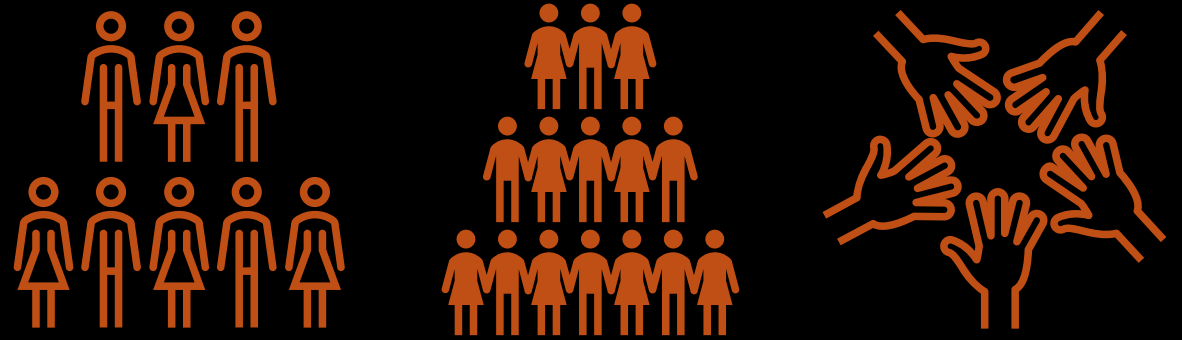
Partners

Does your project have (institutional) partners? If so, briefly discuss who they are and what their role in the project is.

Building a team:

When is it time?

- Reach limits of technical skills
- Grown beyond infrastructure
- Gone beyond your area of expertise



Examples of (Potential) Team Members:

Project Manager

Programmer/Developer

Designer

Content Experts

Systems Admin

Digital Librarian

Educational Specialists

Assessment

People can fulfill multiple positions and there are positions beyond this...

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Building Partners

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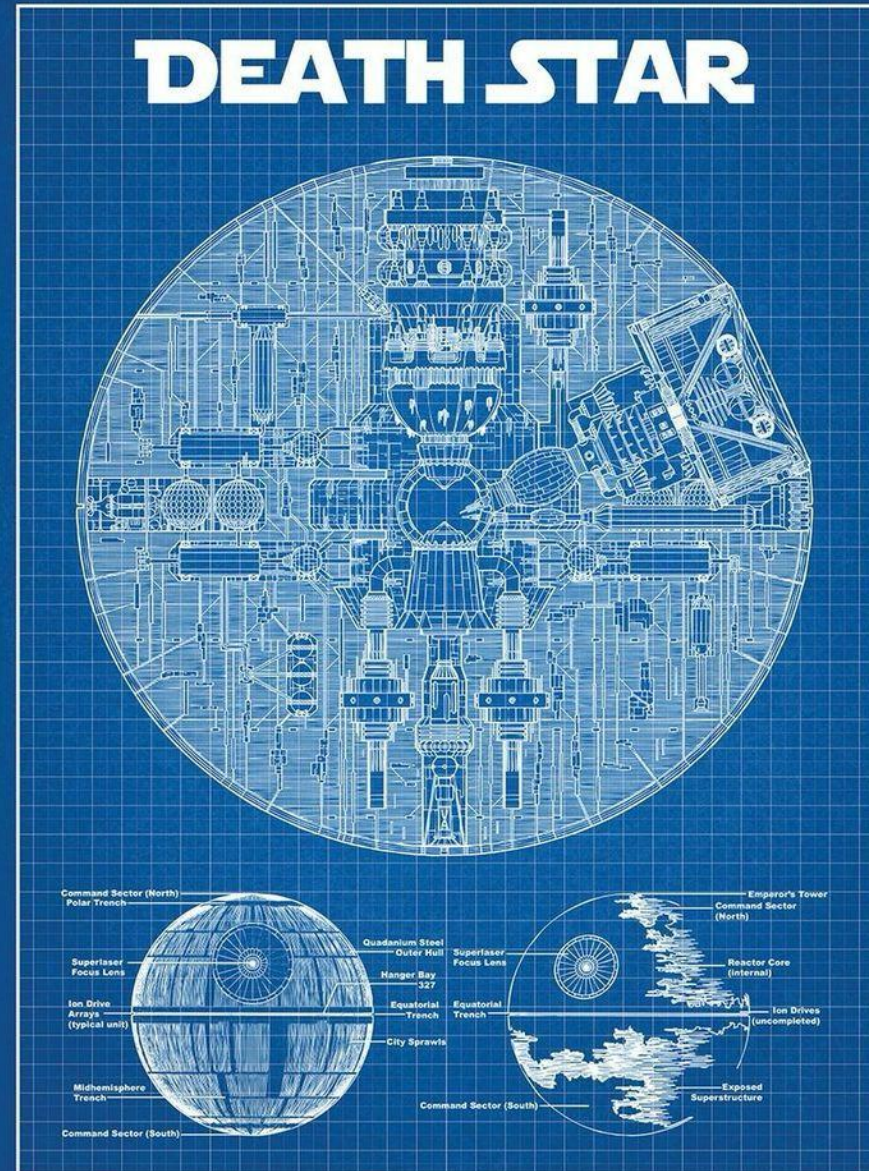
Vision Document

Team Members



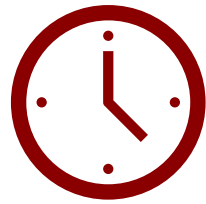
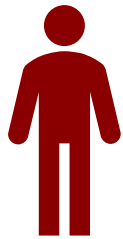
Workplan

Workplan



Building a workplan

Includes:



Spreadsheet:

	A	B	C	D
1	Task	People	Start Date	End Date
2	Create 1st draft of vision document	Jane	5-Jan	10-Jan
3	Contact outreach partners	John	10-Jan	15-Jan
4	Set up funders account	Heather	10-Jan	15-Jan
5	Build pitch website	Janet	15-Jan	15-Feb

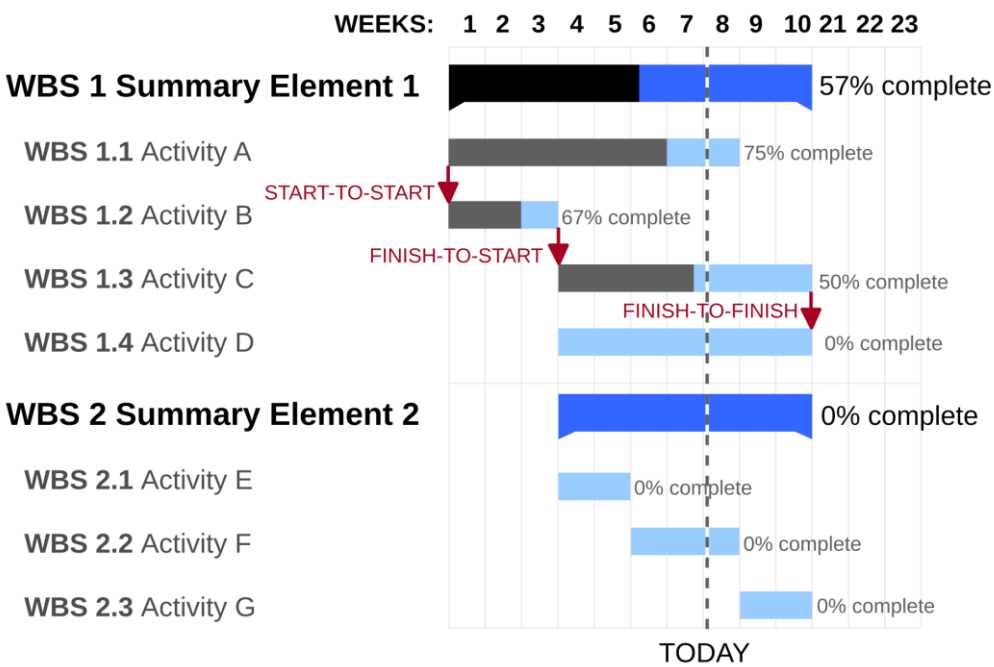
Bullet point list:

Phase 1: Spring 2026

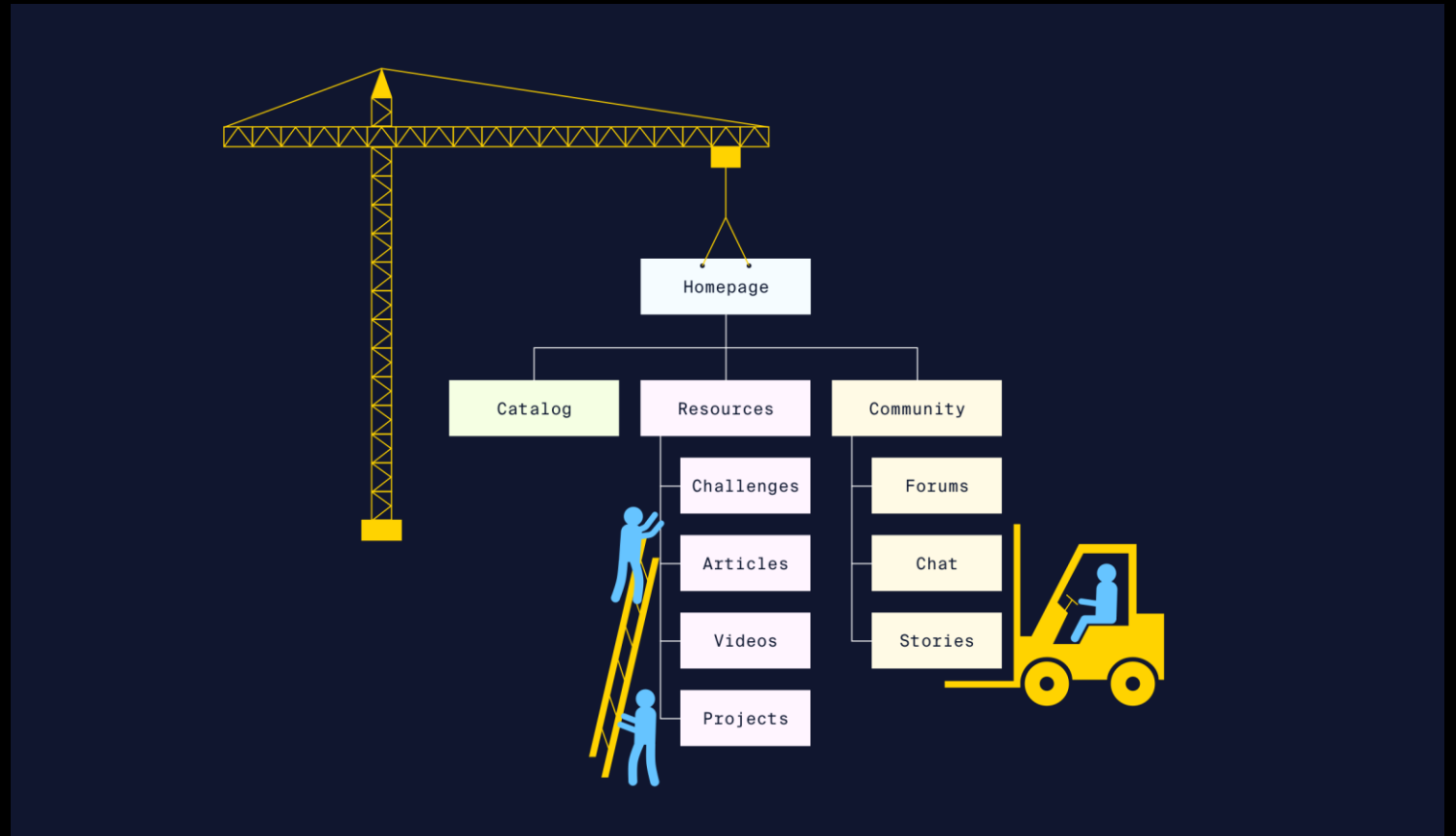
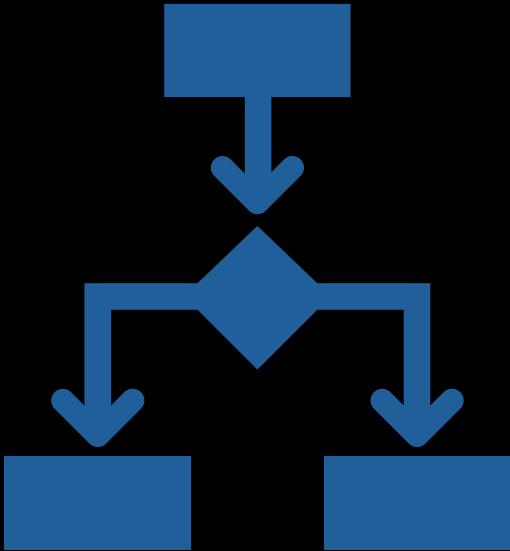
- Create first draft of vision document (Jane)
- Contact potential outreach partners (John)
- Set up account for funders (Heather)
- Build pitch website (Janet)

Phase 2: Summer 2026

Gantt Chart:



Building a spec (specification)



<https://www.codecademy.com/resources/docs/uiux/information-architecture>

Building and nurturing fruitful collaborations

Collaboration creates better projects!

How to collaborate successfully....

- Treat people as collaborators
- Manage expectations
- Recognize interdisciplinary differences
- Clear frameworks for communication
 - Meet regularly
 - Consider how you are going to communicate, manage tasks, schedule, and storage
 - GitHub, cloud services, etc. (MANY options)



Project Planning Lifecycle

Developing the concept

Environmental Scan

Building Partners

Funding

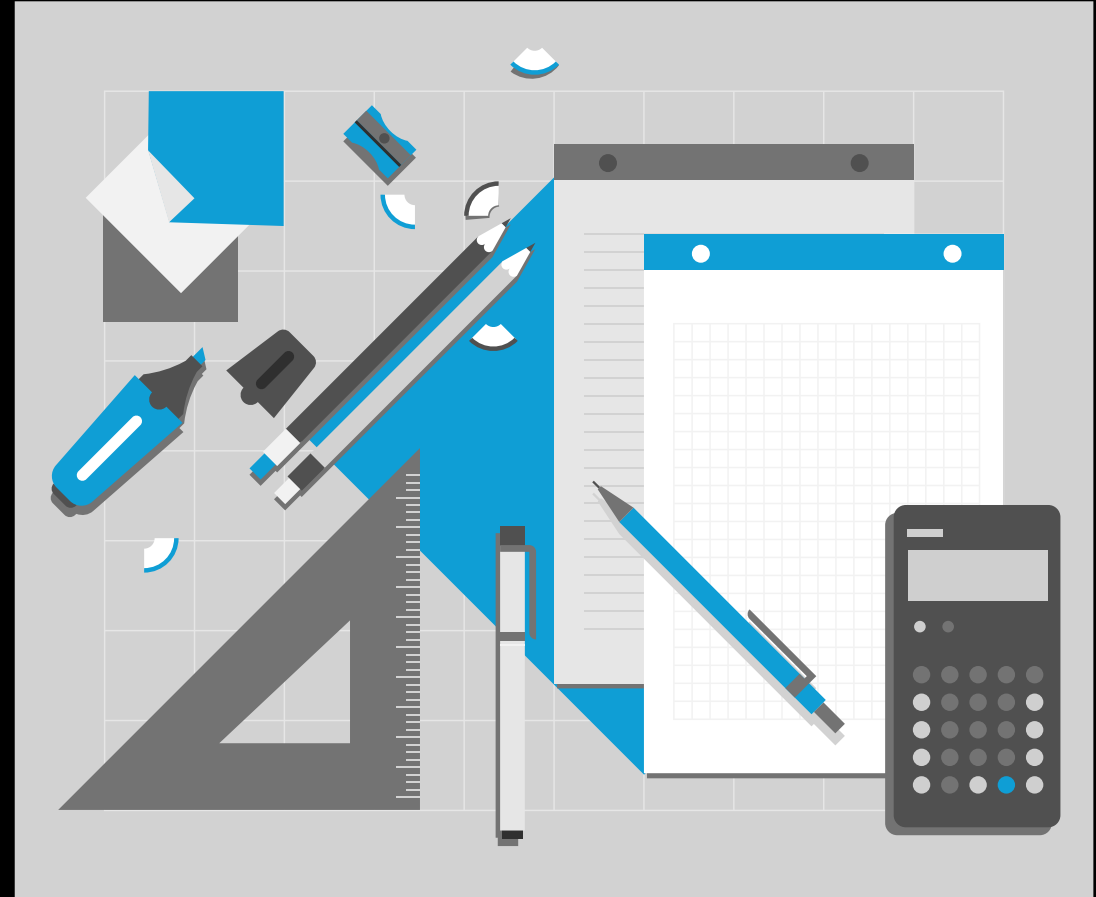
Vision Document

Team Members

Workplan and Spec

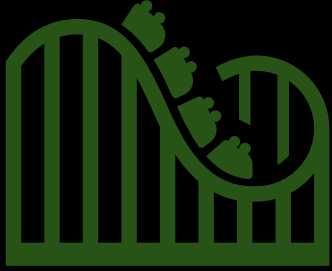


Build!



What happens if you have a change

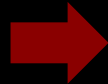
Baseline Change



Scope Change



Feature Creep



When you have a change...



Post-Launch Evaluation

Error Checking

Assessment

Deliverables and Reporting

